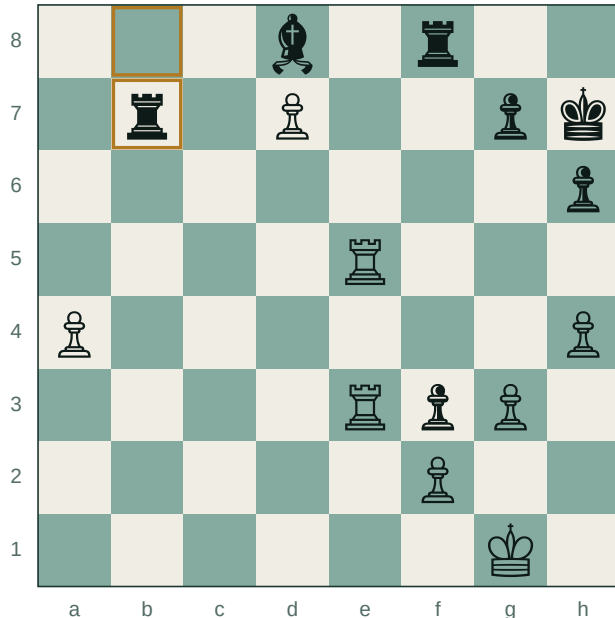


Attraction tactics: White, move 45

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 44...Rb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45. Re8 Rg8 46. Rxg8 Kxg8 47. Re8+ Kf7 48. Rxd8

45.Re8 The rook moves from e5 to e8. From e8 it attacks rook on f8 and bishop on d8. Recorded reply: **45...Rg8**.

46.Rxg8 The rook captures the rook on g8. Recorded reply: **46...Kxg8**.

47.Re8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From e8 it attacks king on g8 and bishop on d8. Recorded reply: **47...Kf7**.

48.Rxd8 The rook captures the bishop on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: rook on f8 and rook on b7. Check for tactical protection.